



One to watch: Uncapped all-rounder Suryansh Shedge was part of the India A team that won the 50-over tri-series in Sri Lanka. SLC

Gambhir-led management as they assess their batting resources and determine whether an overhaul is required.

In the bowling department, India appears to be planning with Australia in mind. With conditions there expected to reward pace and bounce, the management seems keen to build its fast-bowling depth. Prince Yadav, after receiving his ODI cap earlier in June, also made his T20I debut. Alongside Harshit Rana and Prasidh Krishna, Prince is part of India's effort to build a pool of tall, fast bowlers.

Not just in T20Is, the management has also been zeroing in on tall, hit-the-deck bowlers in the ODI setup. In Gurnoor Brar, it has found another reserve option alongside Jasprit Bumrah, Prasidh, Mohammed

Siraj, Harshit, Arshdeep Singh and Prince.

While the T20I side begins building towards the 2028 World Cup, the ODI setup enters a more immediate phase of preparation.

India will play three ODIs in England, where Shubman Gill's side will continue shaping its squad for next year's World Cup in South Africa, Zimbabwe and Namibia.

The series will mark Bumrah's return to the format, his first since the heartbreaking loss to Australia in the 2023 World Cup final. **Injuries and workload management have kept Bumrah away from ODIs for nearly two years, but his presence will be vital as India fine-tunes its combinations in pursuit of the World Cup title.**

The stakeholders will hope both Hardik and Nitish are fully fit by 2027 to bolster both the lower middle order and the bowling attack, giving India the balance every side craves. Should either fail to remain fully fit, Shedge's development over the next

12 months could become a key subplot.

In the batting department, with Virat Kohli and Rohit Sharma now limited to the ODI setup, the duo will once again be in the spotlight across the three games. While Rohit had a couple of decent outings against Afghanistan, Kohli missed the series with a hamstring injury, a rarity in his long and largely unscathed career.

India's squad is more or less settled. But with several quality players knocking on the door, competition for places is bound to intensify, increasing the pressure on incumbents to make an impact. Yashasvi Jaiswal was an unfortunate omission on this tour, largely because of Kishan's resurgence as a multi-dimensional option capable of slotting in anywhere across the top five.

With quality waiting in reserve, and even Rohit no certainty for the World Cup squad, every bilateral assignment from England onwards carries added significance.